

Ultrabooks Shootout

We face off the latest ultrabooks in the market to tell you where you should put your money

Travel-zoom cameras

Check out our travel-zoom camera comparison test



TABLET MANIA

Finally budget tablets emerge that aren't expensive. We size up the competition

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Tablets have come a long way since the launch of the granddaddy of tablets, the iPad way back in 2010. From iPad killers, to budget tablets for the masses, we have seen the tablet market flood with a wide variety of products since then.

But it's only in the past 6 to 10 months that budget tablets have begun to make sense. They

are built decently enough not to look like plastic toys, pack in basic hardware under the hood – will run most games satisfactorily and multimedia will playback without any hiccups. Critically, the battery will last you for a few hours at least.

Budget tablets are essentially aimed at someone who has a limited budget but wants the tablet experience anyway – an entry / first time device, if you will. Consumers too have started realizing the value of the tablet as

a “little bit of this and little bit of that” device. It can't replace your laptop to a certain extent, but is way too big to be your smartphone. You can use the device comfortably as an e-book reader, portable media hub, emails on the move, office suite usage scenario, social networking and a whole lot more.

For this edition of the tablet test, we are testing 15 tablets that are available in the market today, costing less than Rs. 15,000. We have tested them on a variety of

aspects like raw performance, battery life, multimedia, gaming, build and inputs supported to arrive at the final winners.

DESIGN AND PORTS

In terms of design, there are a lot of similarities between these tablets. They all have a 7-inch display (except the Intex iTab that is an 8-incher), have a plastic build and support a wide array of input options. All the tablets have a capacitive touchscreen except the Beitel Magiq, Zync